

upgradeable to Ice Cream Sandwich. Just when is the question. The OS does have major benefits none the less, including high configurability, an excellent notification system, fast Web browsing, and seamless integration with Google applications like Gmail, Google Maps, and Google Talk for video chat.

Lastly, there's RIM's QNX operating system, which runs on the company's BlackBerry PlayBook tablet. Despite having a high end user interface with some very promising features, like tight integration with BlackBerry smartphones, the PlayBook was released well before it was ready, and while RIM has added features since then, the tablet has failed to gain any traction in the market, despite Blackberry dropping its price by more than 50percent.



Tablet using Ice Cream Sandwich Android 4.0

The place where Android lacks behind is a strong selection of apps. It's tough to say exactly how many tablet-optimized Android apps are available, but it's in the low hundreds. RIM claims to have more than 10,000 PlayBook specific apps on its BlackBerry App World, but many big-name apps are still missing. If you want lots of third party apps for your tablet, right now, nothing out there beats the iPad with its 200,000+ programs and games designed specifically for the tablet. Apple's App Store is very well maintained and curated and offers a wide selection no competitor can come close to claiming this right now, partially because apps made for Android tablets have to work across multiple screen sizes, while iPad apps are designed for a single tablet. It sounds simple, but the variation in size (and manufacturers) complicates